ZENTORUM AGENCY · FREE GUIDE

10 things every small business website *needs*

A plain-English checklist to review your site or plan a new one. Ten minutes to read, years of better results.

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A small business website does not need to be huge. It needs to be clear, quick and trustworthy. This checklist covers the ten things every site should have. Use it to review your current site or to plan a new one.

1. A clear headline that says what you do

A visitor decides in a few seconds whether to stay. The top of your homepage should answer three questions: what do you offer, who is it for, and what should I do next? Avoid vague lines like "Welcome to our website". Say "Fresh bread baked daily for your neighborhood" or "Bookkeeping for freelancers". Plain words win. Our guide on writing a homepage that sells goes deeper.

2. An obvious call to action

A call to action is a button or link that tells people what to do: "Call us", "Book a free chat", "Get a quote". Put one near the top, and repeat it further down. Use one main action per page so visitors never wonder what comes next.

3. Easy contact details

If people cannot find you, they cannot hire you. Show your phone number, email and, if relevant, your opening hours and service area. Put them in the header or footer so they appear on every page. Add a short contact form for people who prefer to write.

4. A page that explains your services or products

Describe what you sell in plain language. Say what is included, who it suits and, where you can, what it costs or how pricing works. Clear pricing builds trust and saves you from answering the same questions again and again. Not sure how to think about this? See our guide to website costs for an example of how openness helps.

5. Proof that you are real

People trust other people. Add real customer reviews, photos of your work, logos of businesses you have worked with, and a short About page with your face and your story. Only use real quotes with permission. If you need more reviews, read how to get more Google reviews.

6. A mobile-friendly design

Most people will see your site on a phone. Text should be easy to read without zooming. Buttons should be big enough to tap. Menus should be simple. Open your own site on your phone and try to do the main task. If it is annoying, your visitors feel the same. We explain more in our mobile-first guide.

7. Fast loading pages

Slow sites lose visitors. Big images, too many add-ons and cheap hosting are the usual causes. Compress your photos, remove things you do not use and choose decent hosting. For a full list of fixes, read why your website is slow, and how to fix it.

8. Basic SEO

SEO means making it easier for search engines to understand your site. At the basics level, that means a clear title and description on each page, headings that match what people search for, and your business name, address and phone number written the same way everywhere. Nobody can guarantee a number one ranking, but a solid base helps. New to this? Start with what SEO is or look at our SEO service.

9. Trust and legal basics

Small details tell visitors you are serious:

- A secure connection (the padlock and https in the address bar).
- A privacy policy if you collect names or emails.
- Clear terms for returns, refunds or bookings if you sell.
- Your business name and contact details in the footer.

Rules differ by country, so check what applies to your business.

10. A way to measure and maintain it

A website is not a one-time job. Keep it updated, check that forms still work, and watch simple numbers like how many people visit and how many contact you. Free analytics tools can show this. Use our maintenance checklist to stay on top of it.

Quick scorecard

Give yourself one point for each item below.

- My headline says what I do and who it is for.
- Each page has one clear button.
- My phone and email are visible on every page.
- My services are explained in plain words.
- I show real reviews or examples.
- It works well on a phone.
- It loads in a few seconds.
- Each page has a title and description.
- It uses https and has a privacy policy.
- Someone checks and updates it regularly.

Eight to ten means you are in good shape. Five to seven means a few quick fixes will make a big difference. Under five means it may be time for a rebuild.

What not to add

Just as important is what you leave out. Skip auto-playing music, huge pop-ups on every page, long walls of text and stock photos that look nothing like your business. Every element should help a visitor understand, trust or contact you. If it does not, remove it.

Where to start

You do not need to fix everything at once. Start with the top of your homepage and your contact details. Then add proof, then improve speed and mobile layout. Small steps add up quickly. If you are planning a new site and wondering about the order of work, see how long a website takes to build.

Want a team to take care of all ten? Our web design service starts from $1,250 for sites of up to 5 pages, with 2 rounds of changes included. Send us a message or view our packages, and we will reply within 6 hours.

Quick questions

What is the most important thing on a small business website?
A clear message and one obvious next step. Visitors should know what you do and how to contact or buy from you within a few seconds.

How many pages does a small business website need?
Most start with four: Home, Services, About and Contact. You can add more pages later as the business grows.

Do I need a blog?
Not at the start. A blog can help with search over time, but only if you can keep it up. Focus on the core pages first.

Want us to check your site?

Send us your link and we will reply with what to fix first, plus a clear price if you want us to do it.

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